YUSHENG ZHAO

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EDUCATION

Master in Engineering (M.Eng.), Cyberspace Security Sept. 2023–Jun. 2026
***University of Science and Technology of China (USTC)**, Hefei, China* GPA **4.03**/**4.3** (**92.44**/**100**), rank **2**/**120**

Bachelor of Engineering (B.Eng.), Computer Science and Technology, w/ Distinction Sept. 2019–Jun. 2023
***Xidian University (XDU)**, Xi'an, China* GPA **3.9**/**4.0** (**90.6**/**100**), rank Top **2%**

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS († indicates the corresponding author. ⋆ indicates the co-first authors.)

SciGame: Let Agents Play the Scientific Discovery Games in the Real and Counterfactual World
Yusheng Zhao, Bowei He, Steve Liu, Mingxiao Li
In Submission [Paper][Code][Project]

The Mark Fades: Adaptive Evolutionary Paraphrase-based Attack against LLM Watermarks
Yusheng Zhao⋆, Jian Zhao⋆, Tianle Zhang, Wei Feng, Xuelong Li† (Work done during an internship at TeleAI)
Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL Findings), 2026. [Paper][Code]

Rethink the Role of Deep Learning towards Large-scale Quantum Systems
Yusheng Zhao, Chi Zhang†, Yuxuan Du†
International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2025. [Paper][Code]

Bridging Quantum Computing and Differential Privacy: Insights into Quantum Computing Privacy
Yusheng Zhao, Hui Zhong, Xinyue Zhang, Yuqing Li, Chi Zhang†, Miao Pan†
IEEE International Conference on Quantum Computing and Engineering (QCE), IEEE Quantum Week 2024 [Paper]

Differential Privacy Preserving Quantum Computing via Projection Operator Measurements
Yuqing Li, **Yusheng Zhao**, Xinyue Zhang, Hui Zhong, Miao Pan†, Chi Zhang†
International Conference on Quantum Communications, Networking, and Computing (QCNC), 2024. [Paper]

When Safe Unimodal Inputs Collide: Optimizing Reasoning Chains for Cross-modal Safety in Multimodal Large Language Models
Wei Cai⋆, Shujuan Liu⋆, Jian Zhao⋆, Ziyan Shi, **Yusheng Zhao**, Yuchen Yuan, Tianle Zhang, Chi Zhang†, Xuelong Li†
Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI), 2026. [Paper]

OTHER PROJECTS († indicates the corresponding author. ⋆ indicates the co-first authors.)

Recursive Self-Improvement for AI-Driven Scientific Discovery
SCiEL (As a contributor, with CPIL Lab team, led by Prof. Steve Liu)
[Harness corpus], [RSI Arena]

Executable Construction Records for Guided Quantum Stabilizer Code Search
Yusheng Zhao (Solo project, in progress)
Submitted to Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), AI4Science Workshop, 2026. [Paper][Code]

RSI-Exam: Benchmarking Recursive Self-Improvement through Executable Research
RSI-Exam Team (As a conrtributor)
Preprints. [Paper][Project][Code]

Never Compromise to Vulnerabilities: A Comprehensive Survey on AI Governance
TeleAI AI Governance Team (As a conrtributor, Work done during an internship at TeleAI)
Science China Information Sciences (SCIS), 2026. [Paper][Code]

RESEARCH & WORK EXPERIENCES

Doctoral Researcher Aug. 2026 – now
Machine Learning Dept., **MBZUAI** (CS Ranking #10), UAE | Advised by Prof. Kun Zhang and Prof. Steve Liu **LLM Agent & Causality**

Research Intern Jun. – Aug. 2026
AI4Science Group, **Shanghai AI Lab**, Shanghai | Collaborated with Dr. Mingxiao Li **Multilingual Vintage LLM & Scientific Reasoning**

Master Thesis Jul. 2025 – Apr. 2026
USTC, Hefei | Advisor: Prof. Chi Zhang **Machine Learning-based Quantum Property Estimation**

Research Fellow Intern Mar. – Nov. 2025
AI Governance Group, **TeleAI**, Beijing **LLM Watermark Removal Attack**

Research Assistant Sept. 2024 – Jan. 2025
USTC, Hefei & **NTU Singapore** | Advisor: Prof. Chi Zhang & Dr. Yuxuan Du **Quantum Property Estimation**

Research Assistant Jul. 2023 – Apr. 2024
USTC, Hefei & **UH**, Houston | Advisor: Prof. Chi Zhang & Prof. Miao Pan **Quantum Differential Privacy**

SELECTIVE AWARDS

Full Graduate Scholarship for PhD Programs in Machine Learning MBZUAI 2026
First Class Academic Scholarship USTC 2023 & 2024 & 2025
National Scholarship (Top 0.2%) The Education Ministry of China 2022
Meritorious Winner, Mathematical Contest in Modeling (MCM) COMAP 2021
Outstanding Academic Scholarship XDU 2020 & 2021 & 2022

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, Java, Julia, C, C++, matlab, Lean, GAP
Frameworks: Pytorch, Qiskit, Pennylane, Torchquantum, CUDA-Q, Claude Code/Codex
Languages: Chinese (Native in Mandarin & Wu), English (Fluent)